

General Knowledge

Indian Geography

STUDY NOTES

Natural Vegetation of India

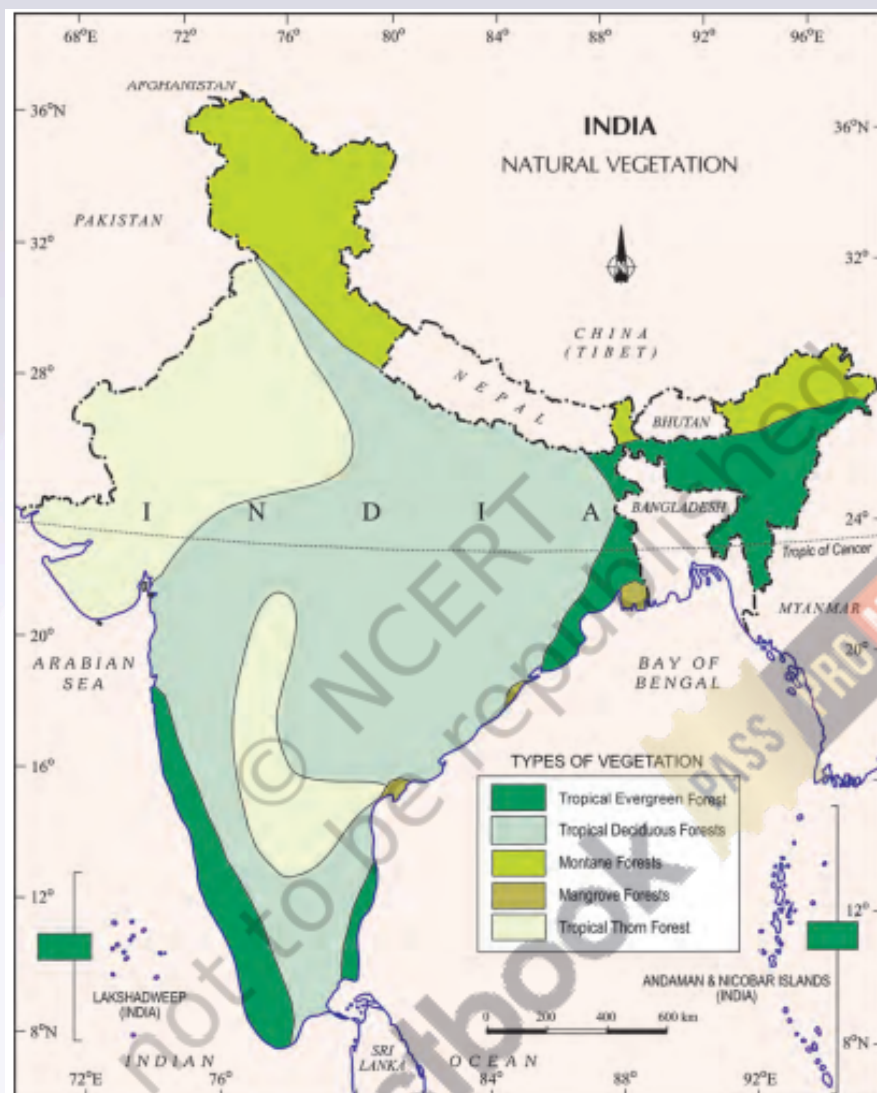


Natural Vegetation of India

India is bestowed with a wide range of flora and fauna. Due to diverse geographical and climatic conditions, an extensive range of natural vegetation grows in India.

Types of Natural Vegetation in India

1. Tropical Evergreen Rain Forests
2. Deciduous or Monsoon Type of Forests
3. Dry Deciduous Forests
4. Mountain Forests
5. Tidal or Mangrove Forests
6. Semi-Desert and Desert Vegetation



Tropical Evergreen Rainforests

Precipitation	More than 200 cm
Location	Northeastern regions: Arunachal Pradesh, Meghalaya, Assam, Nagaland; Western Ghats; Tarai areas of the Himalayas; Andaman Islands; Hills of Khasi and Jaintia.
Key Trees	Sandalwood, Rosewood, Garjan, Mahogany, Bamboo
Vegetation Structure	Multilayered: Includes trees, shrubs, and creepers
Common Animals	Elephants, Monkeys, Lemurs

Deciduous or Monsoon Type of Forests

Precipitation	100 cm to 200 cm
Locations	Lower slopes of the Himalayas, West Bengal, Chhattisgarh, Bihar, Orissa, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Jharkhand, and adjoining areas.
Key Trees	Teak (dominant), Deodar, Blue Gum, Pal Ash, Sal, Sandalwood, Ebony, Arjun, Khair, Bamboo
Characteristics	Trees shed leaves during dry winter and dry summer
Types	Divided into moist and dry deciduous based on water availability

Moist Deciduous and Dry Deciduous forests:

Precipitation	100 cm to 200 cm	70 cm to 100 cm
Locations	Eastern slopes of the Western Ghats, Chhattisgarh, Orissa, Eastern Uttar Pradesh	Central India, rain-shadow regions of the Western Ghats, parts of Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh, Tamil Nadu
Key Trees	Teak, Sal, Shisham, Mango, Arjun, Mahua, Bamboo	Teak, Sal, Khair, Axlewood, Banyan, Bel, Palash, Tendu, Neem
Characteristics	- Trees shed leaves for a short period in dry season - Denser and more lush vegetation	- Trees shed leaves completely in dry season - More open and less dense forest cover
Adaptations	Adapted to areas with moderate rainfall and a short dry season	Adapted to areas with long dry seasons and scarce water availability

Mountain Forests

Location	Found in mountainous regions (e.g., Himalayas)
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Vegetation by Elevation	• Up to 1500 meters (foothills): Evergreen trees like Sal, Teak, Bamboo • Higher slopes: Temperate conifers like Pine, Fir, Oak • Higher elevations: Rhododendrons, Junipers • Above these zones: Alpine grasslands up to the snowfield
Characteristics	Vegetation changes with elevation, from evergreen on lower slopes to coniferous trees and then alpine grasslands at higher altitudes

Tidal or Mangrove Forests

Location	Found along the coast and deltas of major rivers (e.g., Cauvery, Krishna, Mahanadi, Godavari, Ganga)
Special Region	Known as 'Sundarbans' in West Bengal
Key Trees	Sundari (major tree), Hogla, Garan, Pasur
Economic Importance	Provides timber and firewood, important for the timber industry
Coastal Vegetation	Palm and coconut trees beautify the coastal strip

Semi-Desert and Desert Vegetation

Precipitation	Less than 50 cm
Locations	Parts of Gujarat, Punjab, Rajasthan
Key Plants	Thorny bushes, Acacia, Babul, Indian Wild Date
Adaptations	• Long roots and thick flesh • Plants store water in stems to survive drought
Characteristics	Drought-resistant vegetation, adapted to arid and semi-arid conditions

Forest Conservation

Forests play a crucial role in the environment and support life by providing direct and indirect benefits to the economy and society. The conservation of forests is vital for the survival and prosperity of humankind.

Evolution of Forest Policy in India

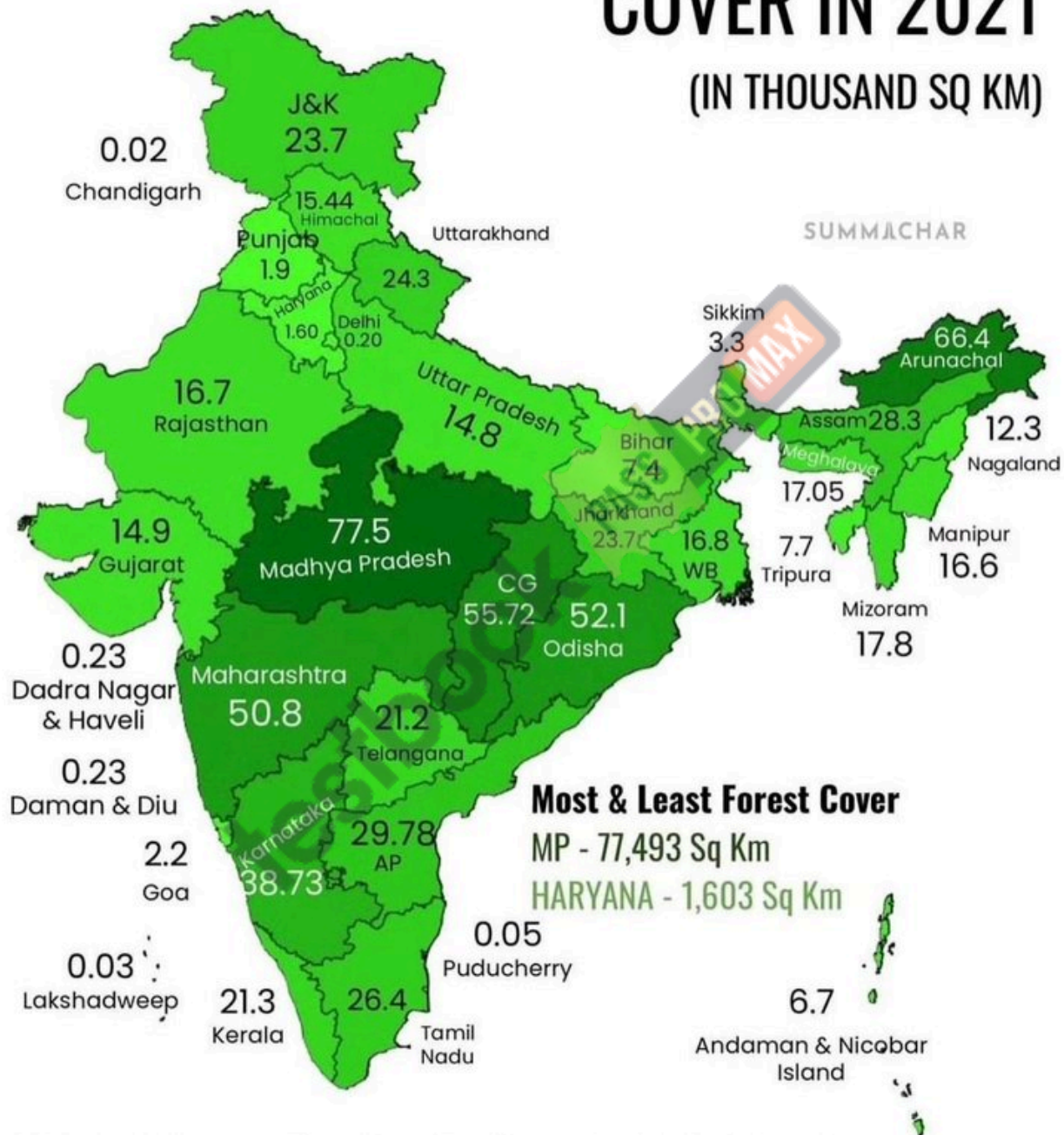
- 1952: First national forest policy adopted by the Government of India.
- 1988: Forest policy revised, emphasizing sustainable forest management.

Key Objectives of the 1988 Forest Policy:

- Bringing 33 percent of the geographical areas under forest cover.
- Maintaining environmental stability and restoring forests where ecological balance was disturbed.
- Conserving the natural heritage of the country, its biological diversity, and its genetic pool.
- Checking soil erosion, preventing the extension of desert lands, and reducing floods and droughts.
- Increasing the forest cover through social forestry and afforestation on degraded land.
- Increasing the productivity of forests to make timber, fuel, fodder, and food available to rural populations dependent on forests, and encouraging the substitution of wood.
- Creating a massive people's movement, involving women, to encourage the planting of trees, stop the felling of trees, and reduce pressure on existing forests.

STATE-WISE FOREST COVER IN 2021

(IN THOUSAND SQ KM)



UTs have not been considered in ranking the most and least data points.